water

how it should be managed and why

in 8 pages

Every creature living on Earth is, at its core, a water-based organism.

Every life function requires the presence of water.

You and every other living thing are made of cells, which evolved in water and still to this day need a water-rich environment in order to live, even though, together, they can form a terrestrial organism like you or a tree - water is still crucial for any form of active life.

The topic of water is nowadays inseparable from discussions about plastic.
In a previous short-form magazine, we spoke about how plastic affects your health and how to at least reduce your exposure to ingesting and inhaling it (because you most certainly do).
The issue is no longer limited to the presence of plastic in marine organisms as it was popular to notice. It is currently also widely found in human bodies as well.
One of the biggest sources of exposure comes from plastic water bottles. Sadly, the issue is much bigger than just plastic water bottles. This is mainly because of the widespread use of plastic pipes.
This issue, however, wasn't always the case.

A brief history of how water was distributed:

3000 B.C.E. – 1920 A.D.

Water was transported through lead pipes into ceramic, glass, or other vessels.

This practice lasted until science had developed enough to establish that water containing lead has harmful effects on health.

1920 (and earlier) A.D. – 1980 A.D.

Water was transported through stainless steel pipes into glass bottles.

This practice lasted until a cheaper and lighter material – plastic – was introduced.

1980 A.D. – now

Water is transported through plastic pipes into plastic bottles.

And nowadays, science is beginning to confirm with almost 100 percent certainty that plastic found in our bodies is harmful (see for yourself. Examples of its effects can be found at www.oelfvmag.com).

Thanks to our previous experiences, there is currently no need to investigate the best solution, but to act on what we learned.

More precisely, to reinvest.

Similarly to what we did when switching from lead to metal and from metal to plastic.

Of course, nowadays, water distribution infrastructure is far more developed than ever before. However, luckily, society and technology are also at their peak of development.



The solution would, of course, would be to change the way we distribute water.

As usually, easier said than done, but ultimately from the governmental point of view it is not impossible. Especially if we would notice, that making this change globally can not only visibly improve human health but also help in the growth of a country's economy (which ultimately human health can alos support).

THE PERFECT PLAN:

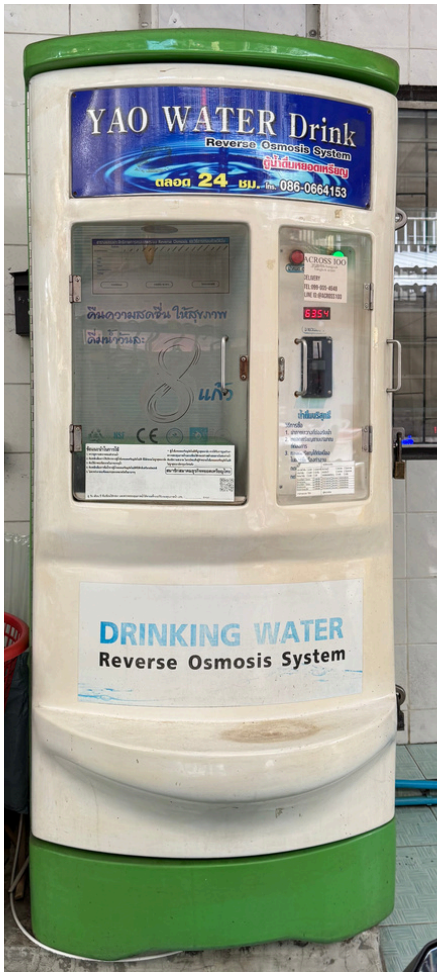
1. Change water pipes to metal ones (enhancing the economies of countries with metal deposits, e.g. Australia, Brazil, Chile).
2. Transport water in metal containers and dispense it into glass bottles at the final destination, to decrease losses during transportation (enhancing the economies of countries with quartz sand deposits, e.g. the USA, China, India).
3. Collect plastic pipes and bottles to make new things from them.*

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*There are countless examples of what we can do with recycled plastic.
One of them, directly related to the subject of water, is creating *water collection points*.

Countries with well-developed plastic processing infrastructure can benefit from this idea (1). And they can additionally help less-developed countries (2).
1) By producing water collection points and selling them globally.
2) By buying plastic suitable for recycling which is highly accessible in many poorer countries.

The solution of water dispensing machines is very popular in Thailand. Throughout the country, there are many, the same looking water collection points. You can insert any amount of money and obtain as much water as you need (a specific fee applies only to larger quantities). We could also add the option to buy a reusable cup from the machine for people who have forgotten theirs or don't have one of their own. We could also add bins dedicated to these cups next to the machines, making recycling them even easier.



We can make the machines in any shape made of the recycled plastic (collected for example from old water infrastructure or from countries with plastic waste issue). A universal design could help improve access to water, regardless of where you are on Earth.

From recycled plastic (both from the deposits we already have in abundance and from old plastic pipes and bottles as said), **we can also make:**

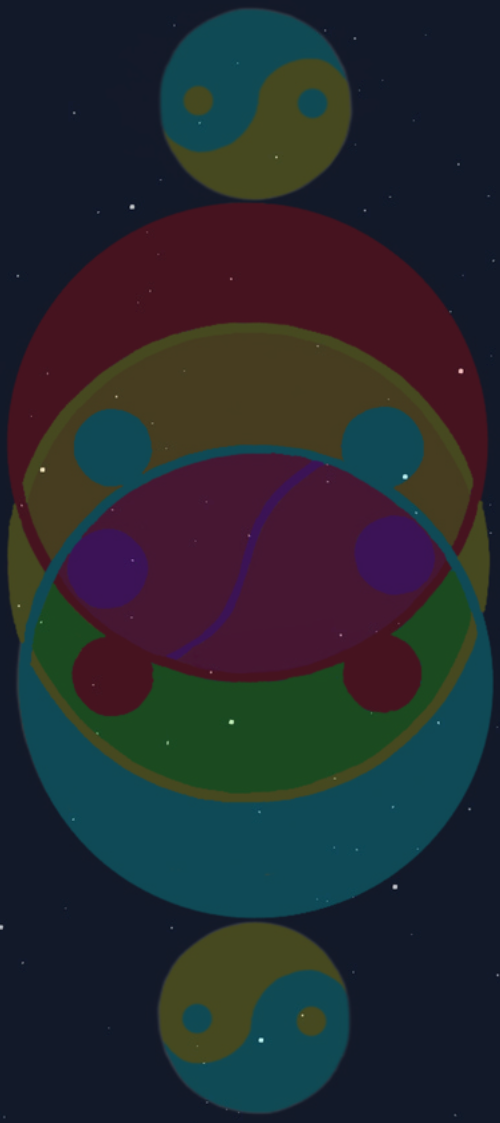
- Good-looking bins in sufficient quantities to make littering unreasonable.
- Roads (like India does)
- Bricks (for instance there is one growing business in Kenya which specializes in making durable and absolutely usable bricks from plastic waste).
- Benches, bus stops (and city infrastructure in general).

the future vision :

Ideally, we consume water from glass or metal reusable bottles.
We can obtain water from water dispensing machines.
Water is widely distributed through metal pipes.
Every country has contributed in some way to this change, giving it an opportunity to boost its economic growth. And plastic from old infrastructure has been reused to make new water collection points, as well as other useful things like decent amount of trash bins.

We no longer use plastic to keep our water in it (since it most certainly releases microplastics which we then consume) nor for clothing (because clothing can create plastic dust which we inhale).

All thanks to recognizing the value of worlds knowledge and how it can make life better and easier for everyone who lies under its used postulates.



With an increasing number of studies and growing evidence that plastic found in human bodies is harmful, and following confirmation of where this plastic comes from, we can assume that countries unwilling to change are knowingly and actively contributing to harm human health (including their own citizens).

AND if you live in a democratic country, REMEMBER – you can always make a change. The path towards it is clear, but the timeline is uncertain – you can achieve it in years or in a month (with a good plan, it mainly depends on luck). But

if you really crave the change, here is what you can do:

1. Develop a highly detailed plan. It must include a comprehensive description, implementation methods, potential obstacles and their solutions, projected outcomes, and a full breakdown of costs and profits. IMPORTANT: you don't have to do it alone (explanation in the next point).

2. Find existing organizations directly related to the change you want to introduce. Generate enthusiasm among them and develop a plan together.

3. Clearly and compellingly present the key premises of the proposed change and rally support in the form of numerous, verifiable votes. The voices of both experts and ordinary residents matter – the latter are crucial to the voting outcome. If they want this change, a politician seeking to implement it will see – well in advance – the potential for voter support.

4. Once you have a detailed plan and support in the form of votes, you can approach the relevant governing bodies directly. Ideally, start with the official responsible for the area you wish to change – for example, if you want schools to introduce classes on the importance of water, approach the Minister of Education.

Hopefully, they will either recognise and support the vision or feel the pressure of the number of supporters they could lose. And hopefully, the more countries pursue the same solution, the more others will follow.

And maybe one day, there will be a party that provides the world with solutions that are objectively the best for everyone, so that everyone would happily follow.